What do reforms do?
Beliefs and support for economic policies

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Why do we disagree on economic policy?

Zucman tax : a proposed 2% wealth tax on very wealthy households.
↪ **A** supports it, **B** opposes it.

Do they differ in their **values** or in **what they think the policy will do?**





If difference in values: respect preferences

If difference in beliefs about what policies do: estimate, discuss, reconcile

This paper

① What are people's beliefs about policy impacts?

- Design a survey eliciting support and beliefs about **29** economic reforms, run on a large French sample
- Map into the standard **public finance model** for welfare analysis

② How much variation in support do beliefs explain?

- Map **beliefs** to **support**
- Compare explanatory power with predictors studied in the literature

③ How do beliefs help understand differences in support?

- Between-group: the **partisan gap**
- Between-policy: support for **pre-** over **redistribution**

④ How do beliefs compare to economists' estimates?

- How **accurate** are beliefs?
- How **elastic to information** are beliefs?

Findings

1. Policy impact beliefs are a **key predictor** of support for economic policies
   - Broadly **corresponds to public finance model** (impact on own wellbeing, on minimum wage workers) but also role of perceived impact on growth
   - Policy impact beliefs explain **more variation in support** than other predictors studied in the literature (**63%** vs. **37%**)
2. Differences in policy impact beliefs explain a large share of the partisan gap, and support for predistributive reforms over redistributive ones
3. Policy impact beliefs are asymmetrical and pessimistic (”reform loss aversion”), and quite inelastic to information

Literature and contribution

1. **Measuring policy impact**: welfare analysis based on incidence, externalities, and cost (Kleven and Kreiner 2006; Hendren and Sprung-Keyser 2020; Kleven 2021)

↪ *Systematically document beliefs about policy impacts*

2. **Determinants of support for redistribution**: from objective self-interest (Meltzer and Richard 1981) to social preferences and attitudes (Cruces, Perez-Truglia, and Tetaz 2013; Kuziemko, Norton, et al. 2015; Alesina, Stantcheva, and Teso 2018; Almås, Cappelen, and Tungodden 2020; Stantcheva 2021; Alesina, Miano, and Stantcheva 2023; Chinoy et al. 2026)

↪ *Identify policy impact beliefs as a key determinant of support*

3. **Support for climate policies**: role of policy impact beliefs (Carattini et al. 2017; Douenne and Fabre 2022; Dechezleprêtre et al. 2025)

↪ *Extend that framework to a wide range of economic policies*

Conceptual framework

The survey

Mapping beliefs to support

Decomposing the partisan gap

Preference for predistribution

Assessing beliefs

Framework: Support for economic reforms

PLANNER

- The planner's problem:

$$\max_p W(p) = \underbrace{\sum_j \psi^j U_j(p)}_{\text{welfare-weighted sum of utilities}} \text{ s.t. } \underbrace{G(p) \leq 0}_{\text{gov's budget constraint}}$$

- Reform dp_k improves welfare if:

$$\frac{dW}{dp_k} = \sum_j \psi^j \underbrace{\frac{dU_j}{dp_k}}_{\text{incidence}} - \mu \underbrace{\frac{dG}{dp_k}}_{\text{effect on budget}} > 0$$

INDIVIDUAL

- Individual i's ideal society:

$$\max_p W_i(p) = \underbrace{\sum_j \psi_i^j \mathbb{E}_i U_j(p)}_{\text{own weights, perceived } U_j} \text{ s.t. } \underbrace{\mathbb{E}_i G(p) \leq 0}_{\text{perceived } G}$$

- Individual i supports reform dp_k if:

$$\frac{dW_i}{dp_k} = \sum_j \psi_i^j \underbrace{\mathbb{E}_i \frac{dU_j}{dp_k}}_{\text{perceived incidence}} - \mu_i \underbrace{\mathbb{E}_i \frac{dG}{dp_k}}_{\text{perceived effect on budget}} > 0$$

Applying the framework

How to test the explanatory power of this framework?

1. Directly elicit
   - support of individual i for reform $dp_k \rightarrow s_{ik}$
   - i's beliefs about the impact of reform dp_k (incidence, gov's budget) $\rightarrow X_{ik}$
2. Relate support to policy impact beliefs:

$$\underbrace{s_{ik}}_{\text{support}} = \alpha + \beta \underbrace{X_{ik}}_{\text{policy impact beliefs}} + \epsilon_{ik}, \quad \text{where } X_{ik} = \begin{pmatrix} X_{ik}^{incidence} \\ X_{ik}^{budget} \end{pmatrix} \text{ and } \beta = (\psi^1, \psi^2, \dots \psi^N, \mu)$$

Extending the framework

Extend this framework to include:

③ Other effects of reforms (indirect, longer-term) → include **macroeconomic impact** in X_{ik}

$$X_{ik} = \begin{pmatrix} X_{ik}^{incidence} \\ X_{ik}^{budget} \\ X_{ik}^{macro} \end{pmatrix}$$

④ Differences in values and attitudes:

- Differences in beliefs-to-support mapping (**values**) → test for heterogeneity in βs

$$s_{ik} = \alpha + \beta X_{ik} + \Delta\beta \underbrace{(X_{ik} \times Z_i)}_{\substack{\text{interacted policy} \\ \text{impact beliefs}}} + \epsilon_{ik}$$

- Differences in other predictors studied in the literature (**attitudes**) → add Y_i (ideology, zero-sum thinking, trust in government, ...)

$$s_{ik} = \alpha + \beta X_{ik} + \gamma \underbrace{Y_i}_{\text{attitudes}} + \epsilon_{ik}$$

Conceptual framework

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Mapping beliefs to support

Decomposing the partisan gap

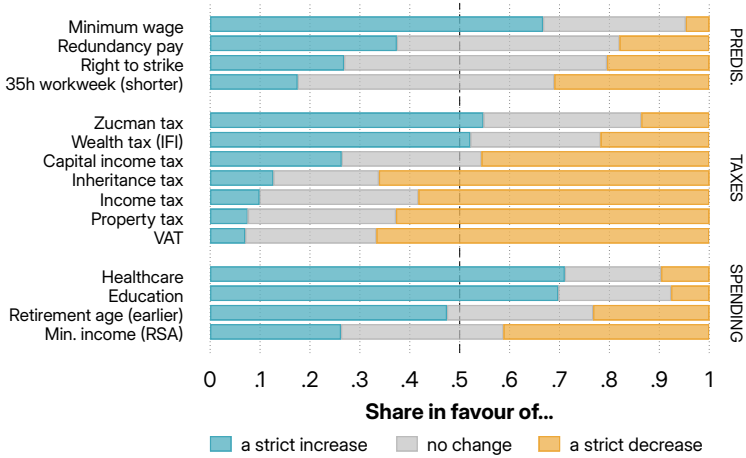
Preference for predistribution

Assessing beliefs

Survey and policies

support for individual reforms | representativity

- Custom survey (N = 7,000+) ran on French individuals, measuring support, beliefs, attitudes, and demographics
- 15 policies: predistributive, taxes, spending



Comprehensive set of reforms

- 2 possible reforms per policy: one increasing, one decreasing
- Each participant is allocated one predistributive, one tax, one spending reform
- **Person-level** and **person × reform-level** variation

person-level variation

Person	Ideology	Reform	Type	Support	Perc'd own incidence
1	Left-wing	Min. wage ↑ €50	Predistrib.	Def. in favour	Prob. benefits me
		Wealth tax repealed	Tax	Def. opposed	Doesn't affect me
		Retirement age ↓ 1yr	Spending	Sw. in favour	Def. benefits me
2	Centre-right	Redundancy pay ↓ 5%	Predistrib.	Sw. opposed	Prob. harms me
		Top income MTR ↓ 4p.p.	Tax	Def. in favour	Doesn't affect me
		Education budget ↓ 2%	Spending	Def. opposed	Def. harms me

person × reform-level variation

Eliciting support

$$\frac{dW_i}{dp_k} = \sum_j \psi_i^j \, \mathbb{E}_i \frac{dU_j}{dp_k} - \mu_i \, \mathbb{E}_i \frac{dG}{dp_k}$$

- **SUPPORT** Imagine the following reform: [reform]. Would you be in favour or against such a reform?



Eliciting beliefs: Incidence

$$\frac{dW_i}{dp_k} = \sum_j \psi_i^j \, \mathbb{E}_i \frac{dU_j}{dp_k} - \mu_i \, \mathbb{E}_i \frac{dG}{dp_k}$$

- **INCIDENCE** If [reform was passed], how do you think the material wellbeing of the following individuals would be affected?
  - Yourself
  - Someone earning €800 a month in benefits [Welfare recipient]
  - Someone earning €1,300 a month in labour income [Minimum wage worker]
  - Someone earning €2,200 a month in labour income [Median wage worker]
  - Someone earning €3,700 a month in labour income [High wage worker]
  - Someone earning €6,800 a month in capital income [Capital owner]



Eliciting beliefs: Budget impact

$$\frac{dW_i}{dp_k} = \sum_j \psi_i^j \, \mathbb{E}_i \frac{dU_j}{dp_k} - \mu_i \, \mathbb{E}_i \frac{dG}{dp_k}$$

- **Fiscal externality**: out of €100 that this reform would raise if individuals didn't change their behaviour, how much is actually collected?



- **Total effect on the budget**: taking all direct and indirect effects into account, how much do you think is raised?



Conceptual framework

The survey

Mapping beliefs to support

Decomposing the partisan gap

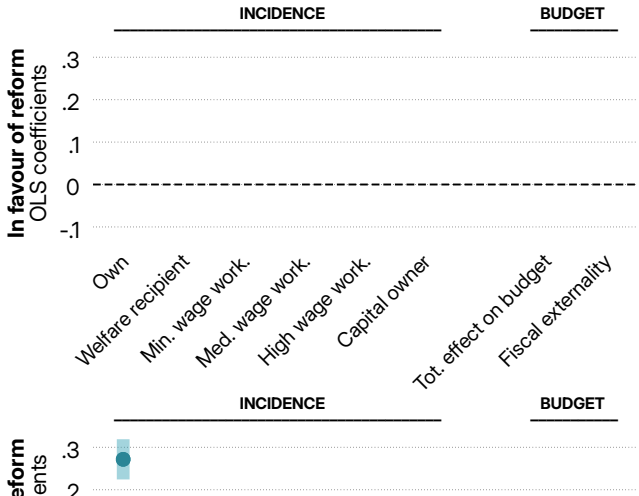
Preference for predistribution

Assessing beliefs

Mapping beliefs to support

w/ reform FE

$$\underbrace{s_{ik}}_{\substack{\text{support} \\ \text{(1 if in favour,} \\ \text{0 otherwise)}}} = \alpha + \beta \underbrace{X_{ik}}_{\substack{\text{policy impact} \\ \text{beliefs} \\ [-.5, .5]}} + \epsilon_{ik}$$



Macro impact

Does incidence capture everything? → participants may struggle to think of indirect/GE effects, care about longer-term outcomes

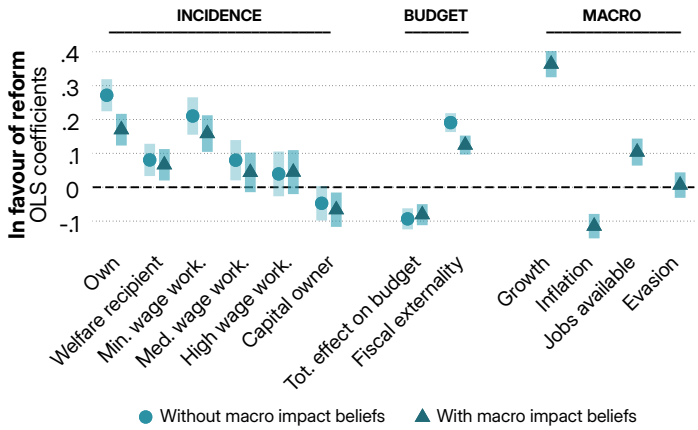
- **MACROECONOMIC IMPACT** Imagine that [reform] is passed. How would the following variables be affected?
  - growth and productivity
  - inflation
  - jobs available
  - tax evasion, tax avoidance, outmigration



Adding macro impact beliefs

w/ reform FE | correlation between beliefs | most/least popular reform

$$\underbrace{s_{ik}}_{\text{support (1 if in favour, 0 otherwise)}} = \alpha + \beta \underbrace{X_{ik}}_{\text{policy impact beliefs, including macro impact}} + \epsilon_{ik}$$



Predictors from the literature: attitudes

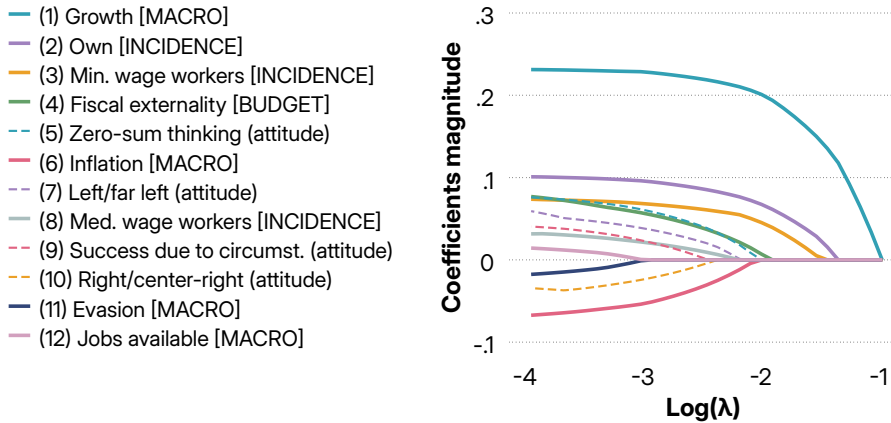
How do policy impact beliefs compare to other predictors of support for redistribution?

- **Ideology** (Far right to Far left) — **political views**
- **Zero-sum thinking** (a group getting richer comes at the expense of another group)
- **Success** due to **circumstances rather than effort**
- **Inequality** entails harmful **externalities** — **views on the functioning of the economy**
- **Goverment efficiency** (Share of tax revenue that effectively benefits citizens)
- **Prefers public funds to cash** (Prefers an excess in tax revenue to be spent by gov. rather than distributed in cash)
- **Prefers a transfer to a wage increase** — **trust in government**

Find the strongest predictors of support

by policy type

- **Growth** is the strongest determinant of support (among all beliefs, attitudes, and controls)

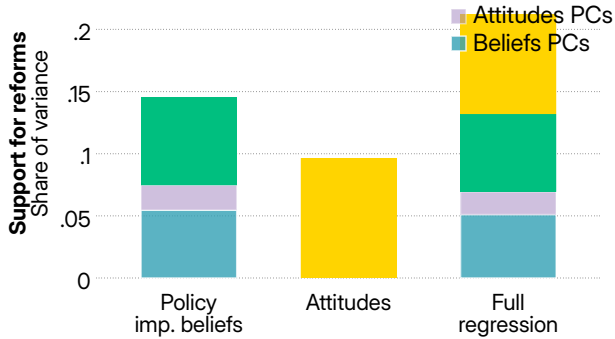


- For 24 out of 29 reforms, the top predictor of support is a policy impact belief

R^2 decomposition of support

$$\underbrace{s_{ik}}_{\text{support}} = \alpha_k + \beta_k \underbrace{X_{ik}}_{\substack{\text{policy impact} \\ \text{beliefs}}} + \gamma_k \underbrace{Y_i}_{\text{attitudes}} + \epsilon_{ik}$$

- **Beliefs** (incidence, budget, macro) explain **63%** of the explained variation in support
- **Attitudes** explain **37%**



Conceptual framework

The survey

Mapping beliefs to support

Decomposing the partisan gap

Preference for predistribution

Assessing beliefs

Decomposing the partisan gap

Why do left- and right-wing individuals differ in their support?

1. Disagree on **what policies do** → different policy impact beliefs
2. Differ in their **values** → different beliefs-to-support mappings
3. Differ in their **attitudes**

Run a Oaxaca-Blinder decomposition:

$$\underbrace{\bar{s}_{ik}^{L} - \bar{s}_{ik}^{R}}_{\text{difference in support}} = \underbrace{\beta^{L}\left(\bar{X}_{ik}^{L} - \bar{X}_{ik}^{R}\right)}_{\text{(1) expl'd by average policy impact beliefs}} + \underbrace{\left(\beta^{L} - \beta^{R}\right)\bar{X}_{ik}^{R}}_{\text{(2) expl'd by values (coefficients on beliefs)}} + \underbrace{\gamma\left(\bar{Y}_{i}^{L} - \bar{Y}_{i}^{R}\right)}_{\text{(3) expl'd by average attitudes}} + \underbrace{\alpha^{L} - \alpha^{R}}_{\text{unexplained}}$$

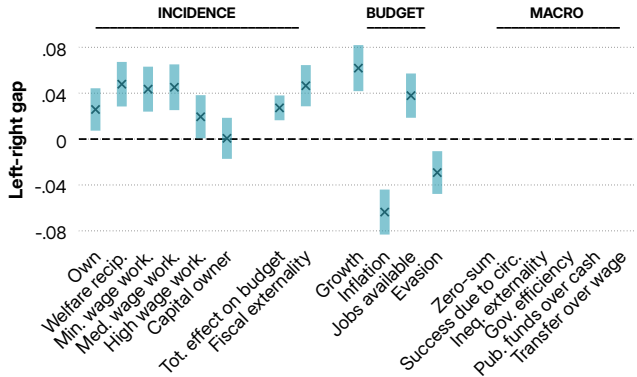
Differences in average beliefs

difference in levels

- How much do left- and right-wing people differ in their average policy impact beliefs?

$$\underbrace{x_{ik}}_{\text{policy impact belief (0/1)}} = \zeta + \chi \times Left_i + \xi \underbrace{Y_i}_{\text{attitudes}} + \eta_{ik}$$

- Sizeable differences for almost all impacts

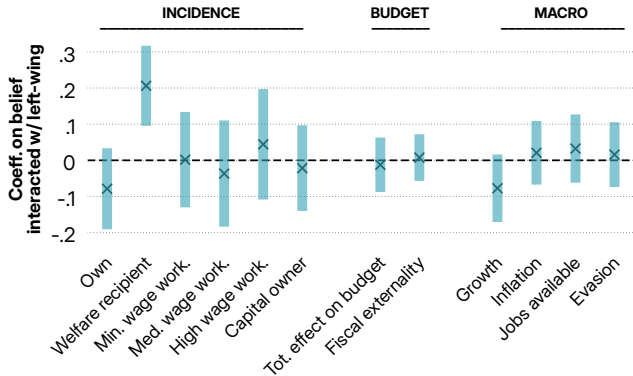


Differences in coefficients

continuous dep. var.

- How much do left- and right-wing people differ in their beliefs-to-support mapping?

$$\underbrace{s_{ik}}_{\text{support (0/1)}} = \alpha + \Delta\alpha Left_i + \beta X_{ik} + \Delta\beta \underbrace{(X_{ik} \times Left_i)}_{\text{interacted beliefs}} + \epsilon_{ik}$$



Oaxaca-Blinder decomposition

top contributors | alt. ref. group | pooled decomp. | full regression

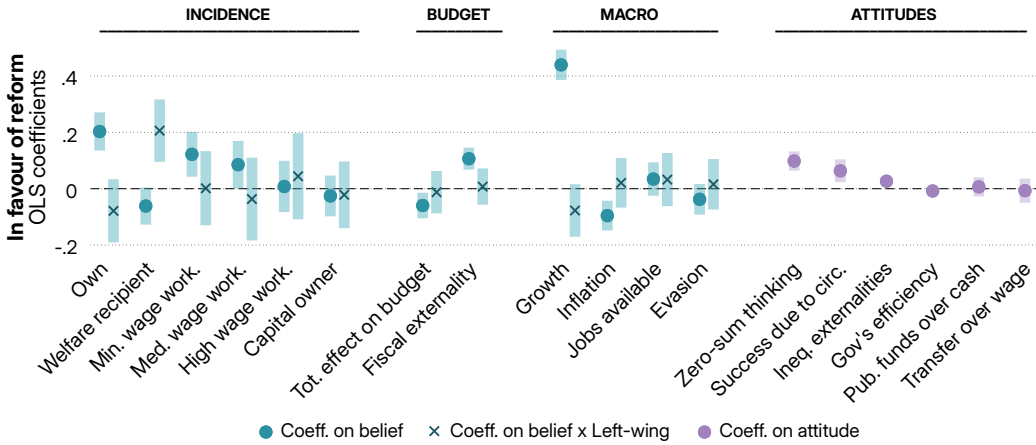
- **Policy impact beliefs** explain **52%** of the explained partisan gap (Growth, Fiscal ext., Welfare recip.)
- **Coefficients on beliefs** explain **17%** (Incidence on Welfare recipients)
- **Attitudes** explain **31%** (Zero-sum, Success due to circumstances)

	Absolute difference	Share of difference (%)	Share of expl'd difference (%)
A. Total difference	0.125	100.0	
B. Explained by difference in average...	0.049	39.3	82.9
Beliefs	0.031	24.5	51.6
Attitudes	0.019	14.9	31.3
C. Explained by differences in weights on...	0.010	8.1	17.1
Beliefs	0.010	8.1	17.1
D. Unexplained	0.066	52.6	

All determinants of support

back

$$\underbrace{s_{ik}}_{\text{support (0/1)}} = \alpha + \Delta\alpha Left_i + \beta \underbrace{X_{ik}}_{\text{policy impact beliefs}} + \Delta\beta \underbrace{(X_{ik} \times Left_i)}_{\text{interacted beliefs}} + \gamma \underbrace{Y_i}_{\text{attitudes}} + \epsilon_{ik}$$



Conceptual framework

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Preference for predistribution

Assessing beliefs

Preference for predistribution over redistribution

Imperfect correlation between support for predistribution and redistribution

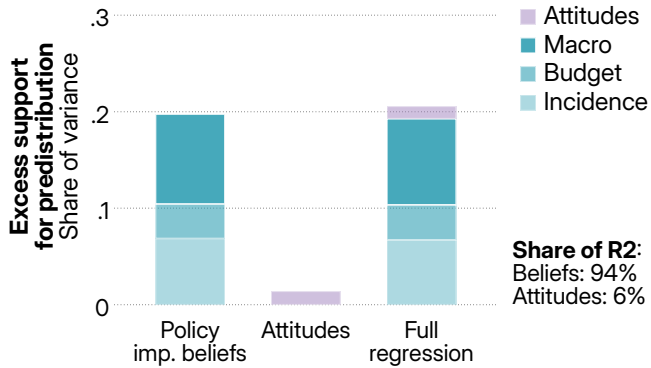
(Saez 2021; Kuziemko, Longuet-Marx, and Naidu 2023; Srinivasan, Valasek, and Wang 2026)

- Can policy impact beliefs explain preferring a type of policy over another?
- Each individual sees one predistributive (P), one tax (T), and one spending (S) reform → can transform support and beliefs:

$$\underbrace{s_{ik}^{P} - \frac{s_{ik}^{T} + s_{ik}^{S}}{2}}_{\text{excess support for predistribution}} = \alpha + \beta \underbrace{\left(X_{ik}^{P} - \frac{X_{ik}^{T} + X_{ik}^{S}}{2} \right)}_{\text{excess beliefs about predistribution}} + \gamma \underbrace{Y_i}_{\text{attitudes}} + \epsilon_i$$

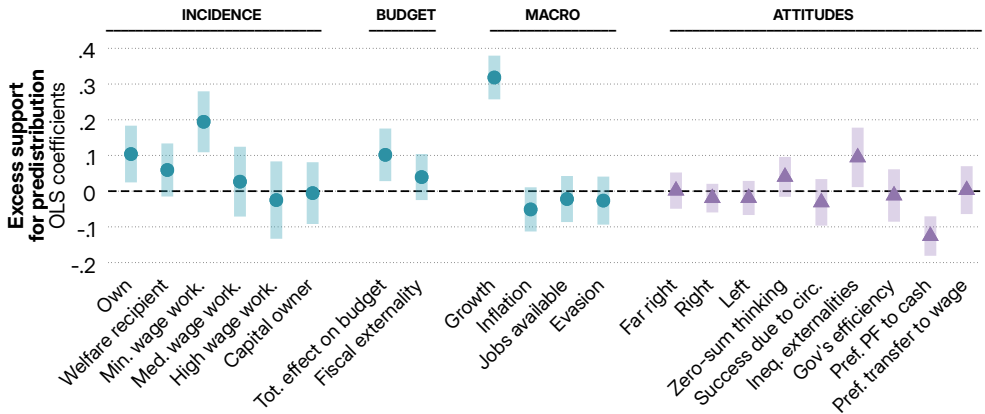
Preference for predistribution over redistribution

- **Beliefs** explain **94%** of the of the explained preference for predistributive over redistributive reforms
- **Attitudes** explain **6%**



Preference for predistribution over redistribution

$$\underbrace{s_{ik}^{P} - \frac{s_{ik}^{T} + s_{ik}^{S}}{2}}_{\text{excess support for predistribution}} = \alpha + \beta \underbrace{\left(X_{ik}^{P} - \frac{X_{ik}^{T} + X_{ik}^{S}}{2} \right)}_{\text{excess beliefs about predistribution}} + \gamma \underbrace{Y_i}_{\text{attitudes}} + \epsilon_i$$



Conceptual framework

The survey

Mapping beliefs to support

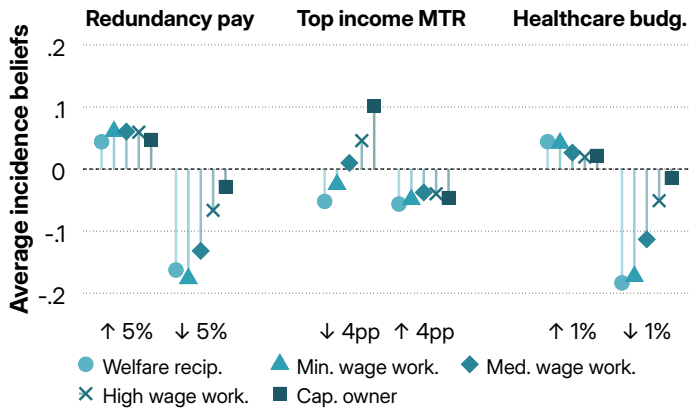
Decomposing the partisan gap

Preference for predistribution

Assessing beliefs

Accuracy of beliefs: symmetry

- Asymmetry → **"reform loss aversion"**



Accuracy of beliefs

- How would support change if individuals had beliefs aligned with the economic literature?

$$\underbrace{\hat{s}_{ik}^{econlit}}_{\text{counterfactual support}} = \hat{\alpha} + \hat{\beta} \underbrace{X_{ik}^{econlit}}_{\text{counterfactual beliefs}} + \hat{\gamma} \underbrace{Y_i}_{\text{attitudes}}$$

- "Overpopular" reforms ($s_{ik} > \hat{s}_{ik}^{econlit}$): **financial wealth reintegrated in the wealth tax base**, Zucman tax is passed, top income MTR decreases by 4 p.p.

Financial wealth reintegrated in the wealth tax base
(Jakobsen et al. 2026)

- negative impact on growth underestimated
- fiscal externality underestimated
- negative impact on employment underestimated

Accuracy of beliefs

gap by individual belief

- How would support change if individuals had beliefs aligned with the economic literature?

$$\underbrace{\hat{s}_{ik}^{econlit}}_{\text{counterfactual support}} = \hat{\alpha} + \hat{\beta} \underbrace{X_{ik}^{econlit}}_{\text{counterfactual beliefs}} + \hat{\gamma} \underbrace{Y_i}_{\text{attitudes}}$$

- "Underpopular" reforms ($s_{ik} < \hat{s}_{ik}^{econlit}$): wealth tax repealed, **education budget increases by 2%**, top income MTR decreases by 4 p.p.

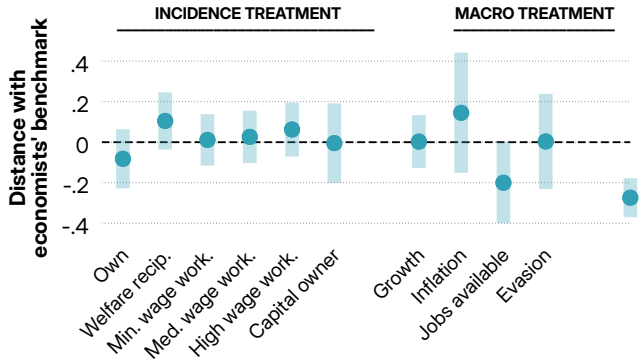
Education budget increases by 2%
(Gethin 2025)

- positive impact on growth underestimated
- positive impact on own wellbeing underestimated
- positive impact on min. wage workers' wellbeing underestimated

Providing information: effect on beliefs

- Treatments T_{ik}: research-based information about a policy's incidence or macro impact
- Little "correction" happening (more so for high-education respondents by education level)

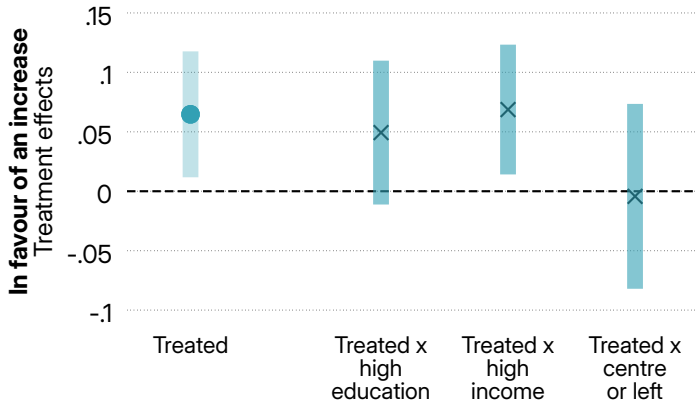
$$|x_{ik} - x_{ik}^{econlit}| = \alpha + \beta T_{ik} + \epsilon_{ik}$$



Providing information: effect on support

- Positive effect driven by high-SES individuals (with smaller misperceptions at the baseline)

$$s_{ik} = \alpha + \beta T_{ik} + \epsilon_{ik}$$



Conclusion

- Policy impact beliefs are a key predictor of support for economic reforms
  - largest welfare weights on yourself and low-income workers
  - not fully utilitarian: people care about macroeconomic effects, especially growth
- Policy impact beliefs help predict differences in support between individuals and between policies
- "Reform loss aversion", with potential for information to increase support, although low-SES respondents are less responsive

Research agenda: do people's views on inequality and redistribution correspond to economic models? If not, why?

↪ Ongoing work: inequality as an inefficiency in parliamentary speech, perceptions of tax evasion

Thank you!

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:// chloedemeulenaer.github.io

Appendix slides

Sample representativity

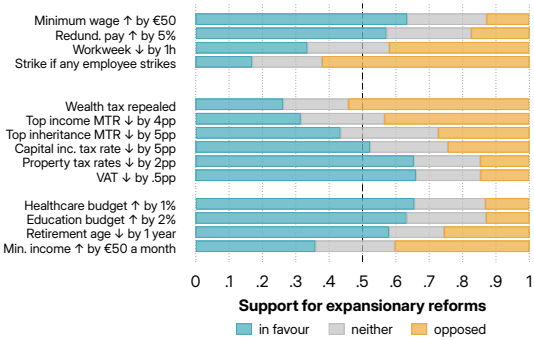
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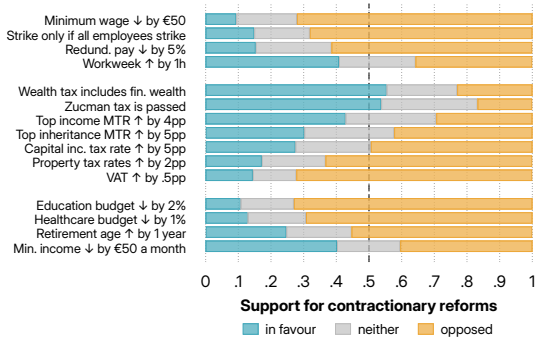
	Survey share	Pop. share
Male	0.481	0.484
50 years old and older	0.482	0.479
Lives in urban area (>50k inhabitants)	0.521	0.537
1st income quartile	0.291	0.250
2nd income quartile	0.252	0.250
3rd income quartile	0.232	0.250
4th income quartile	0.225	0.250
Any tertiary education	0.529	0.364
Unemployed	0.031	0.062
Retired	0.225	0.247
Working sample size	5,912	

Support for individual reforms

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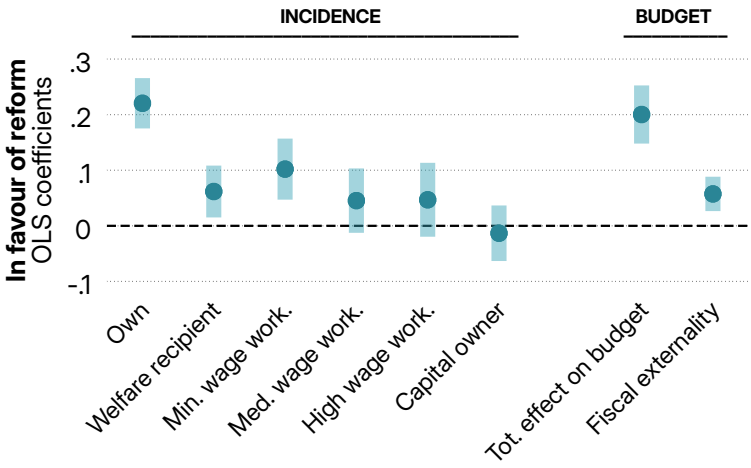
- Ranking of support for reforms consistent with support for an increase/decrease in policies





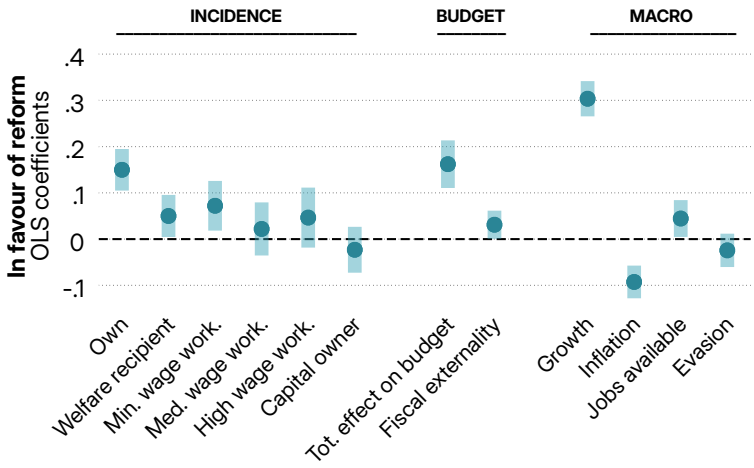
Mapping beliefs to support: adding reform fixed effects

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Mapping beliefs to support: adding reform fixed effects

back



Correlation between policy impact beliefs

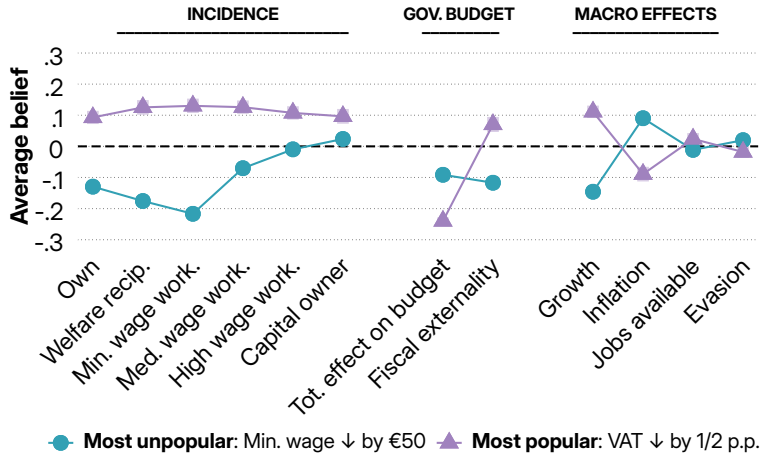
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	Own	Welfare recipient	Min. wage work.	Med. wage work.	High wage work.	Capital owner	Tot. effect on budget	Fiscal externality	Growth	Inflation	Jobs available	Evasion
Own	1.000											
Welfare recipient	0.478	1.000										
Min. wage work.	0.529	0.684	1.000									
Med. wage work.	0.490	0.445	0.661	1.000								
High wage work.	0.365	0.201	0.399	0.677	1.000							
Capital owner	0.255	0.074	0.210	0.492	0.735	1.000						
Tot. effect on budget	-0.071	-0.119	-0.052	-0.039	-0.032	-0.043	1.000					
Fiscal externality	0.129	0.109	0.156	0.142	0.117	0.085	0.168	1.000				
Growth	0.337	0.262	0.320	0.304	0.229	0.178	-0.002	0.230	1.000			
Inflation	-0.070	-0.058	-0.081	-0.077	-0.022	0.007	-0.002	-0.083	-0.131	1.000		
Jobs available	0.251	0.205	0.198	0.179	0.117	0.090	-0.157	0.097	0.430	-0.032	1.000	
Evasion	-0.026	0.022	0.011	-0.007	-0.002	-0.004	0.137	-0.029	-0.001	0.307	0.013	1.000

Most and least popular policies

back

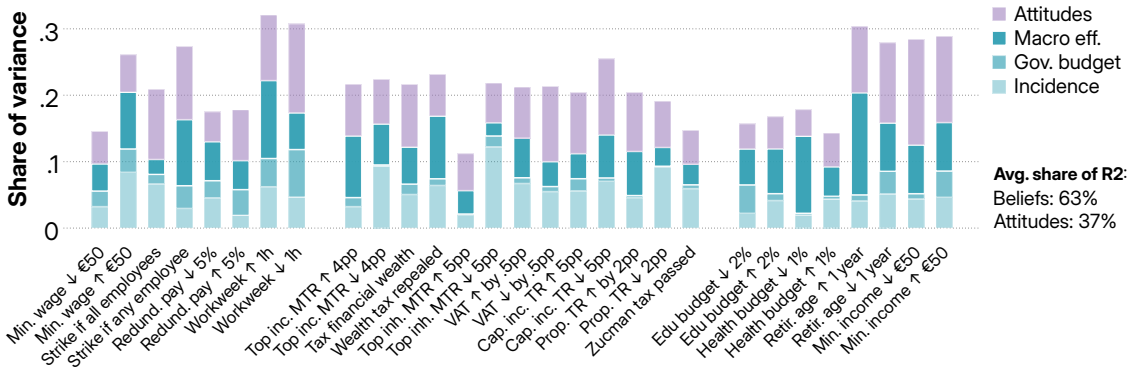
- Average beliefs about the most and least popular policies in the sample



R2 decomposition of support by individual reform

back

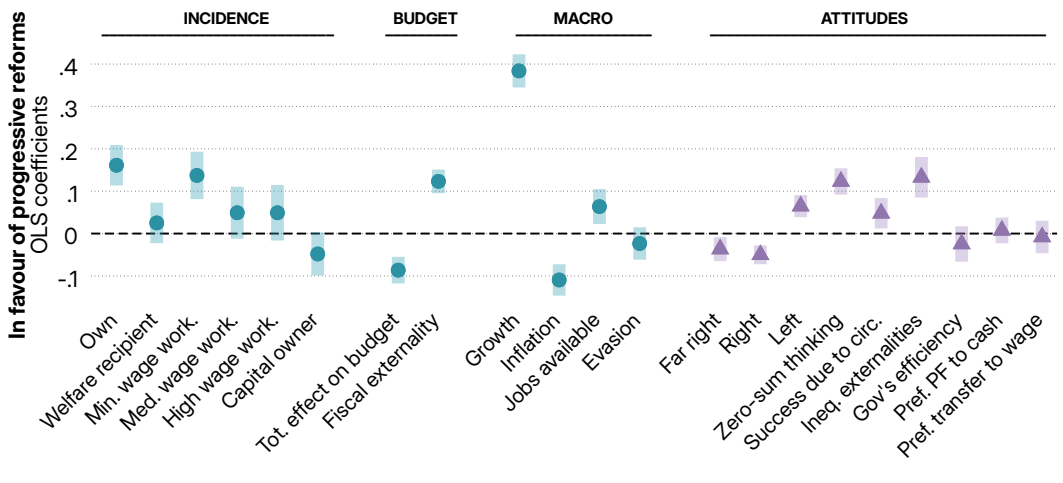
- Averaging across all individual reforms: **beliefs** explain **63%** of variation, **attitudes** explain **37%**



Regression including all beliefs and attitudes

back

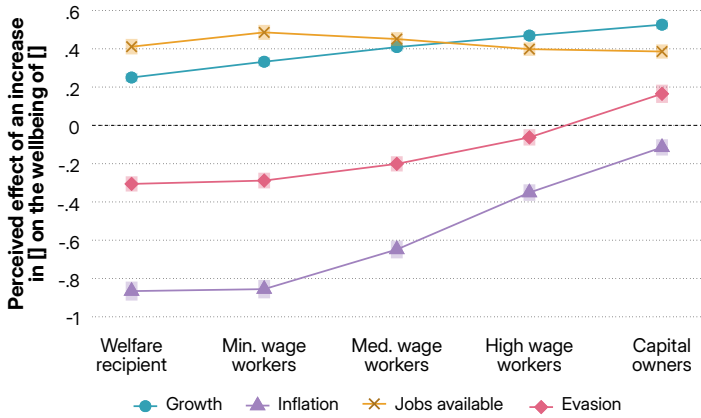
$$\underbrace{s_{ik}}_{\text{support (0/1)}} = \alpha + \beta \underbrace{X_{ik}}_{\text{beliefs}} + \gamma \underbrace{Y_i}_{\text{attitudes}} + \epsilon_{ik}$$



Incidence of macroeconomic impacts

back

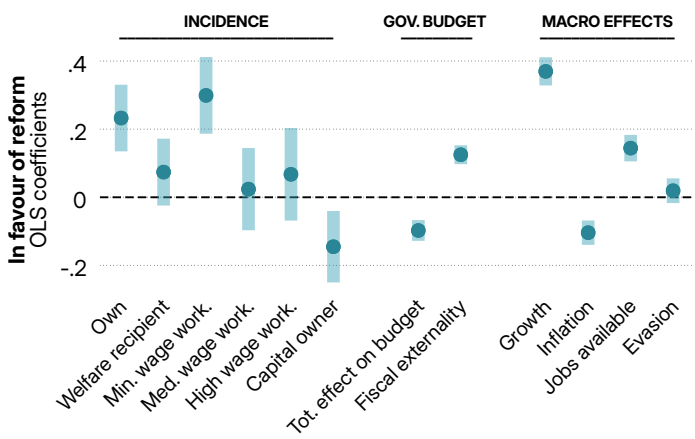
- What is the perceived incidence of macroeconomic impacts?



Including incidence of growth

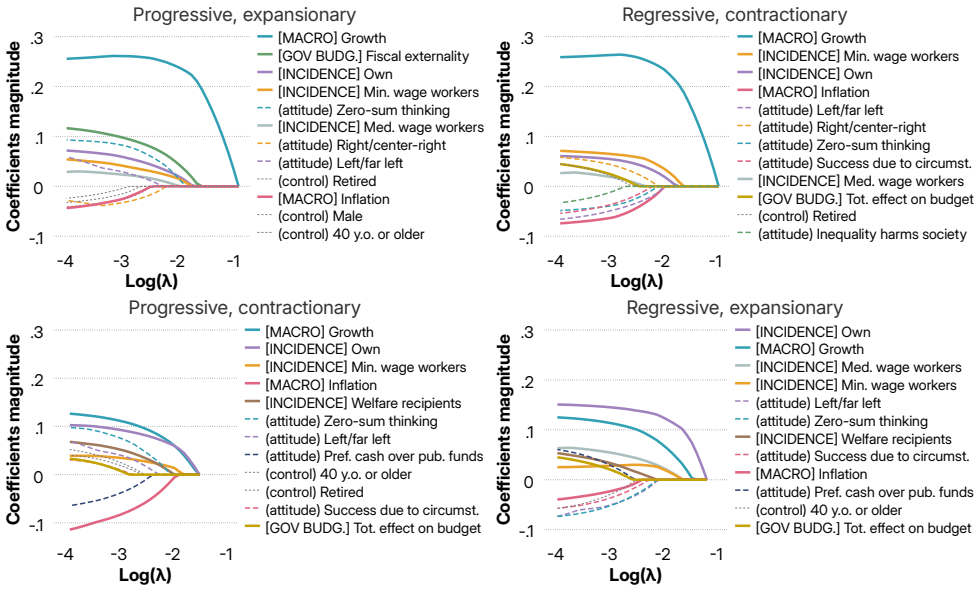
back

- Including impact on growth × Growth incidence into Incidence does not absorb the coefficient



Determinants of support for policies

back

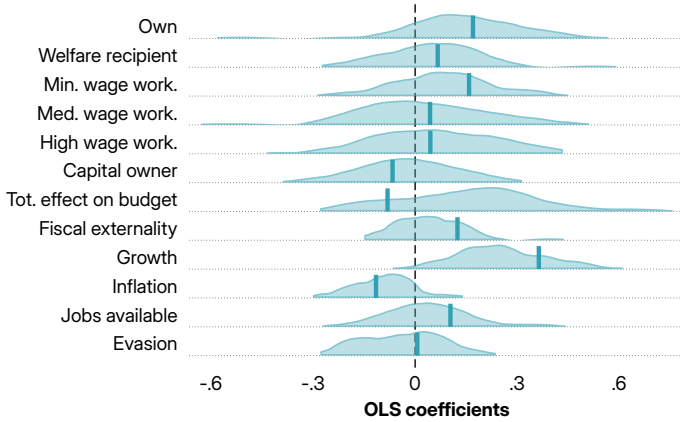


Coefficients on policy impact beliefs across reforms

back

Distribution of coefficients obtained from the 29 individual reform regressions

$$\underbrace{s_{ik}}_{\text{support}} = \alpha_k + \beta_k \underbrace{X_{ik}}_{\text{beliefs}} + \gamma_k \underbrace{Y_i}_{\text{attitudes}} + \epsilon_{ik}$$

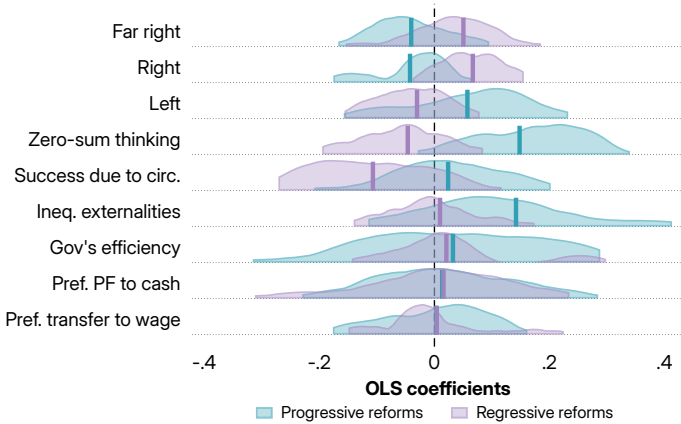


Coefficients on attitudes across reforms

back

Distribution of coefficients obtained from the 29 individual reform regressions

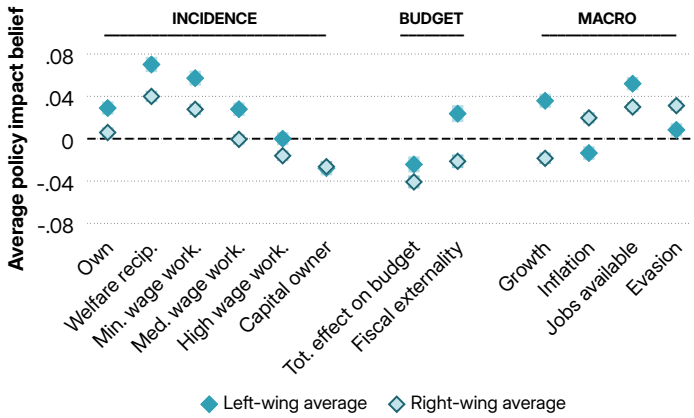
$$\underbrace{s_{ik}}_{\text{support}} = \alpha_k + \beta_k \underbrace{X_{ik}}_{\text{beliefs}} + \gamma_k \underbrace{Y_i}_{\text{attitudes}} + \epsilon_{ik}$$



Differences in average beliefs

back

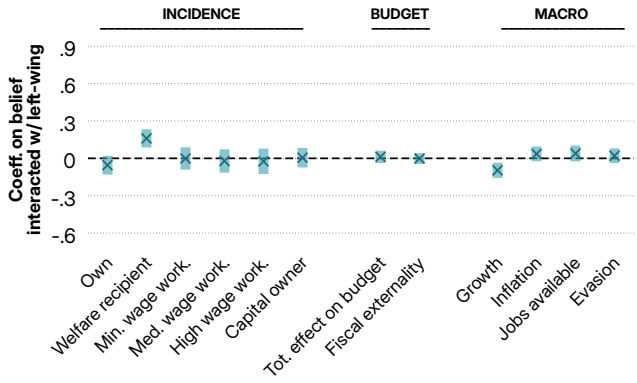
- Average policy impact belief on the left and the right



Differences in coefficients

back

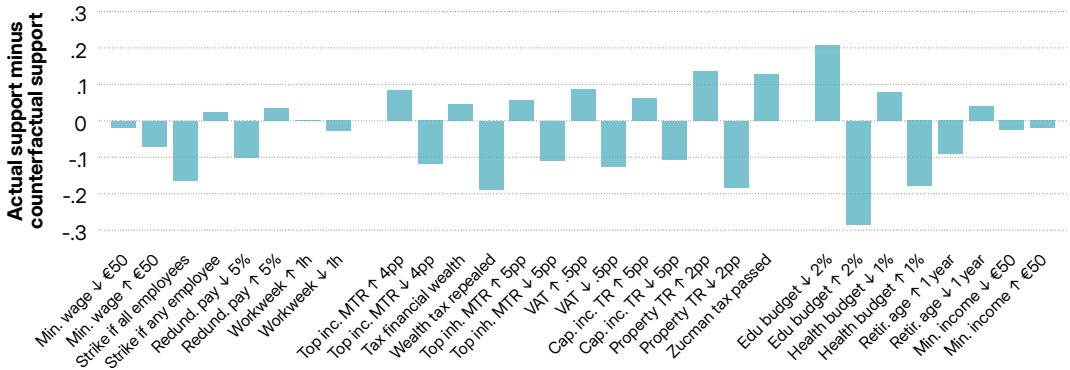
$$\underbrace{s_{ik}}_{\text{support (continuous)}} = \alpha + \Delta\alpha Left_i + \beta X_{ik} + \Delta\beta \underbrace{(X_{ik} \times Left_i)}_{\text{interacted beliefs}} + \gamma \underbrace{Y_i}_{\text{attitudes}} + \epsilon_{ik}$$



Accuracy of beliefs

back

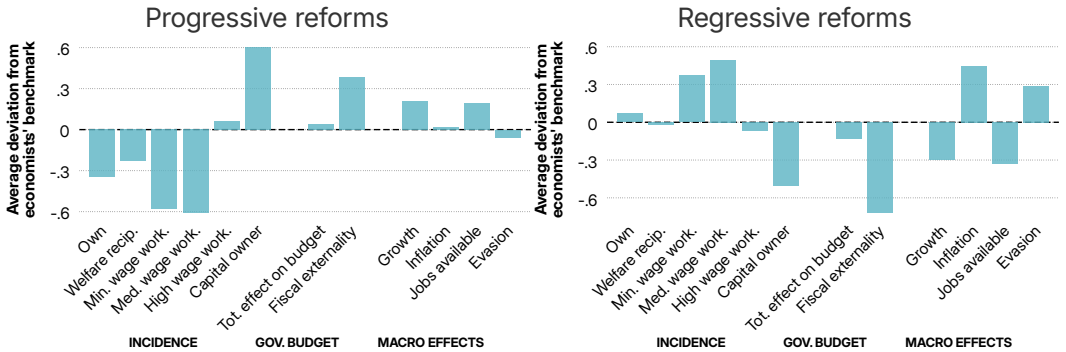
- Actual support - predicted support with economists' beliefs



Accuracy of beliefs

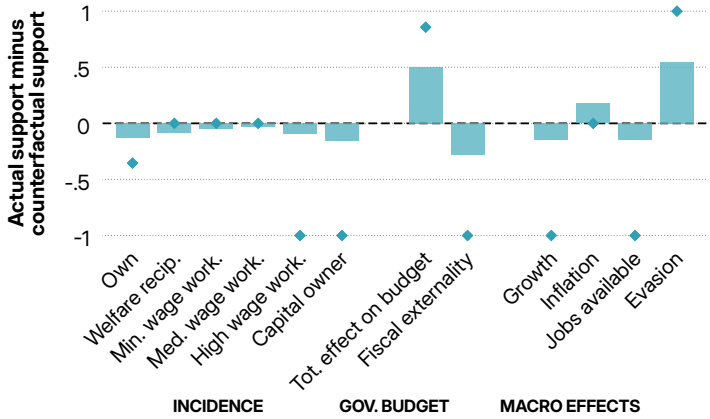
back

- Progressive reforms perceived as less progressive, regressive reforms as less regressive than in the literature
- Larger gaps in macro impacts for progressive than regressive reforms



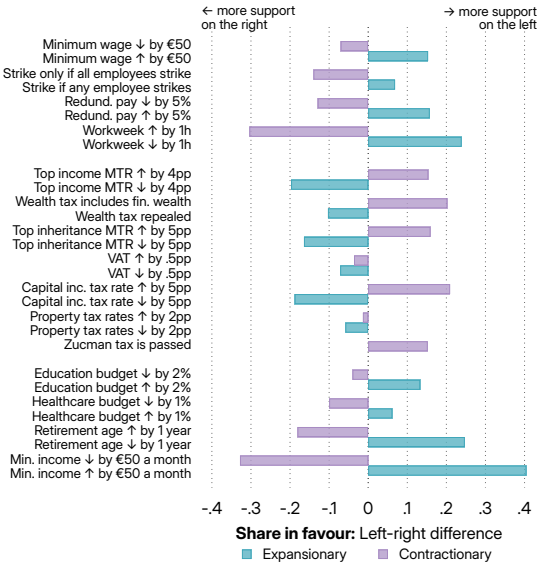
Accuracy of beliefs

back



Decomposing the partisan gap

back



Oaxaca-Blinder decomposition: robustness

back

- Flip the reference group (left-wing coefficients, right-wing beliefs)

$$\bar{s}_{ik}^{L} - \bar{s}_{ik}^{R} = \beta^{L}\left(\bar{X}_{ik}^{L} - \bar{X}_{ik}^{R}\right) + \left(\beta^{L} - \beta^{R}\right)\bar{X}_{ik}^{R} + \gamma\left(\bar{Z}_{i}^{L} - \bar{Z}_{i}^{R}\right) + \alpha^{L} - \alpha^{R}$$

	Absolute difference	Share of difference (%)	Share of expl'd difference (%)
A. Total difference	0.125	100.0	
B. Explained by difference in average...	0.053	42.0	88.5
Beliefs	0.034	27.1	57.2
Attitudes	0.019	14.9	31.3
C. Explained by differences in weights on...	0.007	5.4	11.5
Beliefs	0.007	5.4	11.5
D. Unexplained (difference in constants)	0.066	52.6	

Oaxaca-Blinder decomposition

back

	Absolute difference	Share of difference (%)	Share of expl'd difference (%)
A. Total difference	0.1254	100.0	
B. Explained by difference in average...	0.0527	42.0	88.5
Beliefs	0.0340	27.1	57.2
Effect on growth	0.0138	11.0	23.1
Fiscal externality	0.0038	3.0	6.4
Incidence on welfare recipients	0.0029	2.4	5.0
Attitudes	0.0187	14.9	31.3
Zero-sum thinking	0.0100	7.9	16.7
Success due to circumstances	0.0084	6.7	14.1
Inequality entails harmful externalities	0.0008	0.6	1.3
C. Explained by differences in weights on...	0.0068	5.4	11.5
Beliefs	0.0068	5.4	11.5
Incidence on welfare recipients	0.0064	5.1	10.8
Effect on growth	0.0018	1.4	3.0
Jobs available	0.0012	0.9	2.0
D. Unexplained	0.0659	52.6	

Oaxaca-Blinder decomposition: robustness

back

- Pooled decomposition: no heterogeneity in coefficients

$$\bar{s}_{ik}^{L} - \bar{s}_{ik}^{R} = \beta\left(\bar{X}_{ik}^{L} - \bar{X}_{ik}^{R}\right) + \gamma\left(\bar{Z}_{i}^{L} - \bar{Z}_{i}^{R}\right) + \delta\left(\bar{W}_{i}^{L} - \bar{W}_{i}^{R}\right) + \alpha^{L} - \alpha^{R}$$

	Absolute difference	Share of difference (%)	Share of expl'd difference (%)
A. Total difference	0.125	100.0	
B. Explained by difference in average...	0.059	47.4	100.0
Beliefs	0.034	27.3	57.6
Attitudes	0.025	20.1	42.4
C. Unexplained	0.066	52.6	

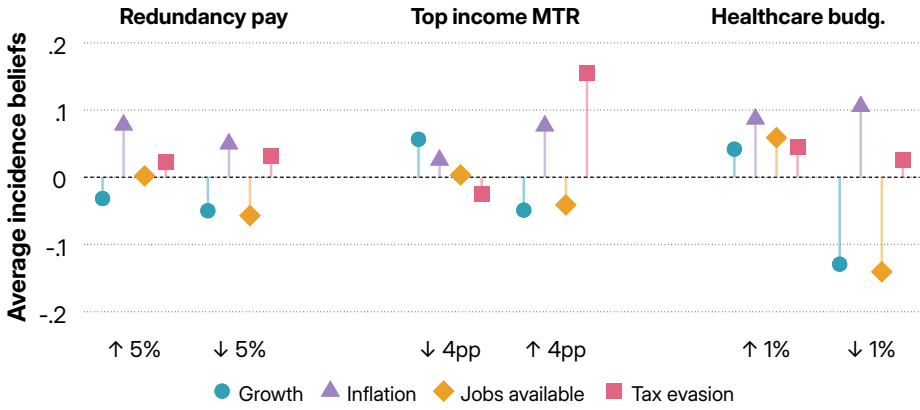
Support for predistribution vs. redistribution

back

Wants pre-distribution to:	Wants redistribution to: Decrease	Stay as is	Increase
Decrease	8.9	4.7	5.0
Stay as is	15.3	14.4	14.4
Increase	10.0	10.9	16.4

Accuracy of beliefs: symmetry

back



First stage: effect on beliefs, by education level

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